
PAPERBOY

MONDAY, AUGUST 17, 2026

Stripe agreed to pay more than \$7bn — by far its largest deal — for the AI-model gateway OpenRouter, as Jared Kushner met Hamas's top negotiator in Egypt for the first such encounter since last year's Gaza ceasefire.

AI

Stripe reportedly agrees to buy AI-model gateway OpenRouter for over \$7bn

WHAT HAPPENED

Stripe has finalized an agreement to acquire OpenRouter, the startup that lets developers route requests across 400+ AI models through one API, for more than \$7 billion, [Bloomberg reported](#) August 16 — a sharp jump from the \$1.3bn valuation OpenRouter set in its May Series B (backers included Sequoia, a16z, Menlo Ventures and Google's CapitalG). It would be Stripe's largest acquisition ever. Neither company has confirmed it: Stripe said it doesn't "comment on rumors or speculation," and OpenRouter declined to comment.

WHAT IT MEANS

Every outlet reporting this traces back to the single Bloomberg story — there's no SEC filing (both firms are private) or press release confirming terms. Treat the \$7bn figure and "finalized" status as reported, not verified.

WATCH NEXT

An official announcement from Stripe or OpenRouter confirming the deal and its actual terms.

SEMICONDUCTORS

Quiet day for chip-specific news. Unitree's STAR Market IPO — priced at ¥150.80/share on Aug 10 — still hadn't started trading as of this writing, despite a debut window guided for Aug 17-21 and heavy gray-market speculation of 170-300% first-day gains that remains unverified against any real trade.

Quiet since Sunday's close — Monday's US economic data (Empire State manufacturing, NAHB housing) hadn't printed as of this run. See AI for the morning's one big deal, Stripe's reported purchase of OpenRouter.

STARTUPS

Quiet for new funding news since Sunday. See AI for Stripe's reported \$7bn-plus purchase of AI-routing startup OpenRouter — the sector's biggest story of the window.

US

Supreme Court sets Tuesday deadline in fight over Trump's White House ballroom

WHAT HAPPENED

The administration's application to the Supreme Court, filed Aug 14 ([No. 26A203](#)), asks the justices to lift a lower-court order blocking construction of a roughly \$400m White House ballroom, calling it "vitally required by national security" and citing, among other incidents, "the threat of a missile attack against Air Force One on July 8." The D.C. Circuit affirmed the injunction Aug 7; it takes effect Aug 21. Chief Justice Roberts set Tuesday, Aug 18, for challengers to respond.

WHAT IT MEANS

Some coverage has attached a Turkey-evacuation story to the missile-threat claim — that detail isn't actually in the Court filing itself, a reminder to check what a document says rather than what's said about it. The underlying fight is over presidential authority over federal property.

WATCH NEXT

The challengers' response due Aug 18, and whether the Court rules before the Aug 21 deadline.

Judge issues second, broader injunction against Trump's mail-ballot order

WHAT HAPPENED

US District Judge Indira Talwani issued a new nationwide injunction Aug 12 in [League of Women Voters of Massachusetts v. Trump](#) (D. Mass., 1:26-cv-11549), blocking the US Postal Service from restricting how it handles absentee ballots. It's separate from, and broader than, her June injunction, which covered only 23 states plus DC. Trump had already asked the Supreme Court on July 27 to lift the June order; the Justice Department says it's "reviewing all options" with the midterms under 90 days away.

WHAT IT MEANS

Two injunctions from the same judge now sit alongside the ballroom case on the Court's emergency docket — one over federal property, one over election administration — giving the justices two live tests of the administration's authority in the same week.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the Court acts on either emergency application before the mail-ballot window for the midterms opens.

Relief reportedly on the way for USS Abraham Lincoln after near-record deployment

WHAT HAPPENED

A senior US commander told the crew of USS Abraham Lincoln that relief is coming, with USS George Washington sailing to the Middle East to take over, according to [USNI News](#), which puts Lincoln's deployment at nearly nine months. A separate Washington Times account of the same remarks could not be independently verified on a repeat fetch, so treat the exact relief timing as unconfirmed beyond USNI's report. Lawmakers have pressed the Navy for answers on crew mental health during the extended deployment.

WHAT IT MEANS

After roughly 265 days at sea — a modern Navy record — a confirmed relief timeline matters for a crew that's been kept in place through the Hormuz standoff with no fixed end date.

WATCH NEXT

Official Navy confirmation of George Washington's arrival and Lincoln's return home.

Kushner meets Hamas's chief negotiator in Egypt, then heads to Netanyahu

WHAT HAPPENED

Jared Kushner met Hamas's top negotiator, Khalil al-Hayya, in El-Alamein, Egypt on Aug 16 — the first such encounter since last year's ceasefire — alongside Board of Peace envoys Nickolay Mladenov and Tony Blair and mediators from Egypt, Qatar and Turkey, per the [Times of Israel](#) and Haaretz. Kushner pressed Hamas to implement the disarmament plan it accepted July 30; al-Hayya said Hamas remains committed but conditioned it on Israel halting strikes and withdrawing. Kushner landed in Israel Aug 17 to meet Netanyahu, who has already rejected Trump's 15-point plan.

WHAT IT MEANS

A weapons handover looks unlikely before year-end — the stabilization force meant to oversee it isn't trained yet — so this is about keeping the process alive, not a breakthrough.

WATCH NEXT

The outcome of Kushner's Netanyahu meeting and whether Israel scales back strikes.

Colombia's earthquake death toll revised down to 289 as duplicate reports are removed

WHAT HAPPENED

Colombia's disaster agency UNGRD put the confirmed death toll from the Aug 8 magnitude-7.4 Chocó earthquake at 289, with 4,187 injured and 143 missing, in its 7:30am Aug 16 report, per [El Tiempo](#). That's down from 294 dead and 320 missing reported the day before — UNGRD said it had cross-checked verbal field reports against Fiscalía and forensic (Medicina Legal) records to remove duplicates. More than 115,000 people across 448 municipalities are affected.

WHAT IT MEANS

The drop reflects better accounting, not a change in fortune — normal in the chaotic days after a major quake, but worth flagging since earlier tolls (294, and before that 281) were each treated as solid when reported.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the missing count of 143 keeps falling as search teams work.

Israeli settlers' siege of Qusra enters a second week

WHAT HAPPENED

Israeli settlers have surrounded Palestinian homes in the West Bank village's Ras al-Ain area since Aug 9, according to [Al Jazeera](#), the only outlet with a detailed timeline. On Aug 14 the Israeli military ordered residents of two homes into one and declared the area a closed military zone, blocking journalists and activists; limited humanitarian access was arranged late in the week through UN coordination. No resolution has been reported.

WHAT IT MEANS

With only one outlet publishing a detailed timeline, treat the specific dates and orders as reported rather than independently confirmed, though the broader siege is corroborated elsewhere.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Israeli authorities lift the closed-military-zone order or the siege continues.

SOURCES

TechCrunch — Stripe will reportedly acquire AI gateway startup OpenRouter for \$7B

Bloomberg — Stripe nears deal to buy AI firm OpenRouter for over \$7 billion

Stripe Newsroom — OpenRouter and Stripe

Supreme Court — Application No. 26A203 (White House ballroom)

CourtListener — League of Women Voters of Massachusetts v. Trump, 1:26-cv-11549

Votebeat — Trump executive order on mail-in voting blocked again

USNI News — USS George Washington heading west as Lincoln deployment nears 9 months

Times of Israel — Kushner, Hamas chief in Egypt for talks on advancing Trump's Gaza plan

El Tiempo — Balance oficial de la UNGRD, 16 de agosto

Al Jazeera — Timeline: the one-week siege of Qusra by Israeli settlers

Longbridge — Unitree Robotics (688836.SH) quote